BITS Pilani
K K Birla Goa Campus

CSIS DDF Usage Policy

DDF Usage Policy

Download Sample NFA for DDF

I. Context

As our DDF increases in amount and our Department gets more people, it is important to have some guidelines on how funds in the DDF can be spent (or not spent). The current source of the DDF is from WILP courses (hereinafter referred to as W-DDF). The other sources, hereinafter collectively referred to as C-DDF, come from the overhead of external projects that the department faculty members bring. C-DDF also has contributions from consulting, and APPCAIR. There is a DDF scrutiny committee who will review and approve a DDF application.

The proposal described below is valid for one year and can be subject to a periodic review after a year.

II. DDF Scrutiny Committee

The committee overseeing the DDF usage comprises of the DRC as permanent members. HOD-CSIS will be a part of the committee by default. The committee will include an Assistant Professor, selected on a rotation basis. The responsibilities are:

i. Review each application for presenting a paper in a conference to decide the extent of support to be provided based on the corpus available, the publication venue and the nature of publication. The decision will be based on the policy defined in **Section III**. The committee will attempt to make a fair distribution among the applicants, should the need arise. [by the committee sans HOD-CSIS]

ii. Final approval- [by HOD-CSIS]

iii. Publish the DDF balance sheet once a year to the department faculty members. [by HOD-CSIS]

III. Research Support [Max 30% of C-DDF and 30% W-DDF]

Department DDF will be used to support conference registration, travel, journal over-length page charges (EPC), **subject to the availability of funds**. The DDF scrutiny committee will perform the selection by following the broad guideline below.

- The support is primarily for accepted papers and the support will be in the form of a "Top-up" subject to conditions mentioned in Table 1. The top-up can be used for registration, travel and accommodation.

- The University also charted a policy for OA Journal Page charges. In view of this, ***DDF will not have any allocation for OA Journals.***

- There will be top-up support for the following three categories:

- **[TOP] Top tier:**

  ✓ **Jour:**This support is provided when there is no university wide support from BITS yet. This support will be withdrawn once there is a university wide support from BITS.
  SciMago Q1, IEEE and ACM Transactions journals (for overlength page charges only)
  Inter-disciplinary society journals whose impact factors are > 5 and is in Q1.

  ✓ **Conf:** Conference venues (Main Track Only) in ***{CSRankings UNION CORE-A*}.***

- **[OTH]**This will be decided by the department level DDF scrutiny committee based on the merit of the paper and the venue. There are following four subcategories:

  OTH-1. ***CORE A main track*** paper

  OTH-2.
  i) ***CORE A* parallel track*** (workshop, symposium, industry tracks **NOT** considered) **AND**
  ii) it is old enough, i.e. running for **at least 5 years AND**
  iii) steering committee comprising of **reputed scholars**. Examples of such tracks are: ICSE-SEIP, ICSE-SEET, ICSE-MSR etc.

  OTH-3. ***CORE B main track***: for **Non-AI** subject areas only

  OTH-4. ***Pen and Pencil Workshops***: DDF shall support participation in a few selected workshops of this kind provided the faculty is one among the invited scholars, selected based on their contributions in the topic or area. The department encourages such participations, since an outcome of these workshops, many times ends up in having a publication at prestigious venues. The following are the selected venues (will be revised time to time):

    I. Dagstuhl
    II. Lorentz Center
    III. Banff, including Banff at CMI, Chennai.
    IV. American Mathematical Society
    V. Hausdorff Research Institute for Mathematics
    VI. Simons Institute at UC Berkeley

Supporting documents: Faculty should provide a **letter of invitation** and a list of scholars (with affiliations) participating in the program.

- **[OTH-Students]** DDF may extend conference registration support to papers **authored** by all full time students only (no faculty member as co-author) for

  a) ***CORE A* workshop, symposium, industry tracks*** (all areas) as well as ***CORE A workshop, symposium, industry tracks*** for **non-AI subject** areas
  b) The venue should be old enough, i.e. running for at least 5 years
  c) steering committee comprising of **reputed scholars**.

- If a conference paper is selected for funding through DDF, the funding given to a faculty can be used for

  - Registration
  - Travel (typically the registered author, or a co-author from BITS Goa only)

The top-up matrix and the selection guideline for conferences is shown in Table 1 .

Table 1 Topup Matrix

Category	Eligibility	Frequency	Criteria	Max Funding
[TOP].Conf.	1. All faculty members and Visiting Full-time faculty. 2. Full-time Students* - AT LEAST one author is a faculty member from CS&IS department and the faculty member chooses not to avail DDF for the same article.	Always eligible, no limit	Criteria defined in TOP.Conf	1.5 Lakhs INR; EVEN if PDA is NOT exhausted
[TOP].Jour			For journals belonging to TOP.Jour	Max USD 500; ONLY if PDA is exhausted
[OTH]		An author is eligible to apply in this category once a year.	Criteria defined in OTH-1	80000 INR; EVEN if PDA is NOT exhausted

Category	Eligibility	Frequency	Criteria	Max Funding
	1. Preferably Assistant Professors and Visiting Full-time faculty. 2. Full-time Students - AT LEAST one author is a faculty member from CS&IS department and the faculty member chooses not to avail DDF for the same article.		Criteria defined in OTH-2	60000 INR; ONLY if PDA is exhausted
			Criteria defined in OTH-3	50000 INR; ONLY if PDA is exhausted
			Criteria defined in OTH-4	40000 INR; ONLY if PDA is exhausted
[OTH-Students]	Full-time Students - authors are students only, NO faculty member, or NO industry mentor as co-author	An author is eligible to apply in this category once a year.	Criteria defined in OTH-Students	50000 INR
Encouragement	Assistant Professors, Visiting Full-time faculty and Ph.D. Students ONLY	Based on the event. One travel per conference without any paper.	A*/A conferences PLUS a few approved conferences (see Appendix A).	25000 INR

*Full-time students refers to all students enrolled in undergraduate, masters and full-time PhD students

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IV. Conference Debriefing: Whoever (faculty/student) is supported by DDF should give a presentation of their work after coming back from the conference. The individual supported by the DDF is expected to book the CSIS meeting room (or other room if this is unavailable) for one hour (45 min + 15 min for questions) and invite all the PhD students and faculty. The presentation shouldn't just be his/her own work but about the conference and the learnings.

a) What's the conference about, its focus, why is it great?

b) What's the focus area/theme this year?

c) About the location. What was the submission volume, acceptance rate, geo distribution of papers, who else from India (or BITS)?

d) What are the workshop themes? They give a clue of the new advancements, upcoming research ideas

e) Lessons learnt from the Keynote talks

f) What do you think is the trend/ or what are your biggest takeaways from this conference

g) What did you present - your work in brief, how did they receive your work (max 15 min)?

h) Describe one paper you liked in this conference (10min)

i) Any possible collaboration?

Note:

1. For **OTH** category conferences (OTH-2, OTH-3, OTH-4), the policy of DDF support as described in the matrix, applies **only when** the PDA is exhausted for a regular faculty. However, PDA restriction doesn't apply to Visiting Full time faculty.

2. The 'Non-AI subject areas' classification is intended to bring parity between AI and Non-AI domains.

3. **Under Encouragement Category**, Ph.D. students are allowed for Indian Conferences only. Under the same category, faculty members (visiting and assistant professors) are eligible for CORE A/A* and a few additional conferences mentioned in Appendix A, BUT NOT for any Indian Conference.

4. If the authors anticipate to use the DDF based on the criteria, they are expected to acknowledge the CSIS department

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Appendix A Approved Conferences (over and above A/A* conferences)

Name	Applicable to
CLEAR	Faculty
ALT	Faculty
DeepMath	Faculty
ICPRAI, CHIL	Faculty

Name	Applicable to
Indian Conferences: IndoCrypt, IndoML, ICDCN, COMSNET, ISEC, CODS-COMADS, AI-ML Systems, SaTML, ICASSP, HRI, FSTTCS, HIPC	Ph.D. students only

This list is subject to a re-evaluation once in each year by the DDF scrutiny committee.

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